

Assignment 1

One Sentence Pitch

Decantr is a wine community platform that helps wine enthusiasts and wine businesses discover, connect, and share wine experiences, making it easier to find wines you'll love.

Explanation of project idea and business model

Decantr is a web-based wine community platform designed to connect wine enthusiasts with wine businesses by digitizing and enhancing the wine tasting experience. The project addresses a key problem in the current wine ecosystem: information is often fragmented, outdated, and unstructured, while wine tastings are still frequently conducted using pen and paper. As a result, both consumers and businesses lack access to structured data and meaningful insights.

To solve this, Decantr provides a centralized platform that allows users to discover wine-related events, track their tasting experiences, and interact with a local wine community. By transforming traditional tastings into a digital and structured format, the platform enables users to easily revisit wines, receive personalized recommendations, and share their experiences with others. At the same time, businesses benefit from a digital solution that replaces manual processes, captures structured customer feedback, and improves visibility among relevant target groups.

The business model of Decantr is based on a multi-sided platform approach. On the one hand, wine enthusiasts are attracted through a free and engaging user experience focused on discovery, community interaction, and personalized content. On the other hand, wineries, wine bars, and event organizers are integrated as paying customers who use the platform to manage tastings, gain insights into customer preferences, and promote their offerings.

Revenue is primarily generated through a subscription-based model on the business side, complemented by additional income streams such as promoted listings and data-based insights. The success of the platform depends on the development of network effects: as more users contribute tasting data and interact within the community, the value of the platform increases for both consumers and businesses.

Overall, Decantr combines elements of community interaction, digital service provision, and data-driven value creation to establish a scalable and sustainable platform within the local wine ecosystem.

I. Customer Segments

Decantr serves a multi-sided market, targeting two customer segments:

First, Wine Enthusiasts marking the B2C segment, that can also be split into two groups: Casual Wine Enthusiasts and Advanced Wine Enthusiasts. Casual Wine Enthusiasts are people that enjoy drinking wine and may be interested in enhancing their ability to taste the notes of a wine. Since they are not advanced in wine tasting, they may just want to track the wines they drank with as little information as "tasted good/bad" or first flavour notes they tasted. As they may not know their ways around the world of wine, they need a way to discover local wine events/tastings by businesses they may not have come across so far. Latter would be also true if new to a region or visiting as a tourist.

Advanced Wine Enthusiasts or even "sommeliers to be" are a heavy demanding group, that is looking for a tool to log tasting notes, track their personal cellars and conduct "blind tastings" for training their palates. They may also be interested in sharing the precious bottles they drank amongst the tasting notes with friends. They are further interested in



less common and more professional wine tasting events, which are harder to find than regular wine events. Hence, a way in which they could see upcoming events in a single place would save them a lot of time.

Both groups have in common that they want a way of tracking wines they drank, a way of sharing those with friends and a way of discovering wine-related events that suit their needs. Further, both may be interested in personalized wine recommendations based on their actual taste preferences.

Second, Wineries, Wine Bars, Event Organizers and any business selling wine not just online, being the B2B segment of the platform. A common problem in marketing events is targeting the desired customers; hence a platform of wine enthusiasts is the dream of a marketing team. When looking at the offered selection of wine, the event hosts have a lack of knowledge about the local taste preferences. Therefore, a platform offering data on those would enhance the offerings of businesses. Further, during and after the event the hosts struggle to receive feedback about the offered wines: If done on paper, either the consumer has to do it twice, once for their notes and once for the host, the papers may get lost, or analysis may be hard due to lots of semi-structured data. The platform solves these struggles by offering real-time sentiment analysis of the consumers' feedback. This even gives the host the chance to exchange part of the offering during the event, personalizing the offerings to the consumers at hand. Another area where businesses can benefit is the regular situation when a customer walks into a store wanting to buy wine by the recommendation of the seller. Here the seller could largely benefit from knowing the wines the customer drank and how they liked it, to do a personalized recommendation.

II. Value Propositions

Decantr creates value by connecting wine enthusiasts and wine businesses within a shared digital ecosystem, where structured interactions and shared experiences benefit both sides of the platform.

For wine enthusiasts (B2C), Decantr provides a centralized solution to discover, experience, and remember wine-related activities. Users can digitally track their wine experiences through a structured wine journal, allowing them to easily revisit previously tasted wines **or share those with friends**. The platform further enables blind tasting modes, supporting both social experiences among friends and more structured evaluations for advanced users. In addition, Decantr simplifies the discovery of wine bars, events, and local offerings by aggregating relevant information in one place. Based on users' past interactions and preferences, the platform also provides personalized recommendations **on which types of wine or flavour notes they prefer e.g. with notes of green apple**, helping them find wines that match their individual taste.

For businesses (B2B), Decantr offers a digital solution to streamline and enhance wine-related operations. The platform replaces manual, paper-based tasting processes with a structured event and tasting management system, enabling more efficient organization and evaluation. At the same time, businesses benefit from real-time customer feedback, which is aggregated into clear and actionable insights to better understand customer preferences and improve offerings. **Additionally, with customers understanding their personal preferences better through the personalized recommendations, wine sellers can sell them wines fitting their desires better.** Furthermore, Decantr increases the visibility of wine bars, wineries, and event organizers by connecting them directly with a relevant audience of local wine enthusiasts and allowing them to promote events and products in a targeted manner.



III. Customer Relationships

Building trust and engagement requires tailored relationship strategies for both sides of the platform.

For wine enthusiasts (B2C), Decantr focuses on community-driven engagement and long-term retention. Initial trust is established through local pop-up events and tastings, where users can experience the platform in a real-world setting. This is complemented by educational content distributed via social media and blog formats, which helps users especially beginners develop their wine knowledge and stay engaged. Within the platform, long-term retention is supported through personalized recommendations and social interaction features, fostering an active and connected community.

For businesses (B2B), Decantr emphasizes close and collaborative partnerships. Early-stage relationships are built through direct onboarding and personal outreach, guiding partners in setting up and using the platform. These relationships are further strengthened through continuous feedback loops and co-creation, allowing businesses to actively shape the platform and integrate their existing processes. In the long term, Decantr provides ongoing support by helping partners interpret customer feedback and optimize their offerings, ensuring sustained value from the platform.

IV. Channels

Decantr utilizes a combination of direct and indirect channels to reach both wine enthusiasts and business partners. The primary channel is the web application itself, which serves as the central interface for all interactions.

To acquire and onboard business partners, Decantr relies on direct communication channels such as targeted email outreach and digital communication. In addition, on-site integration plays a key role, as QR codes placed at partner venues and events allow users to directly access the platform and participate in tastings.

Furthermore, Decantr leverages digital marketing channels, including search engine optimization and social media, to attract users and increase visibility within the local wine community.

V. Key Activities

To successfully operate its business model, Decantr focuses on three core activities.

First, continuous platform development and maintenance are essential to ensure a stable and user-oriented web application. The platform must be regularly improved and adapted based on user feedback, particularly from early adopters.

Second, data processing and analytics play a central role in creating value for business customers. User-generated tasting data is transformed into structured and interpretable insights, which are used to support business decision-making.

Third, B2B sales and onboarding are critical to building the platform ecosystem. Decantr actively acquires and supports business partners to drive adoption and establish the network effects required for long-term success.

VI. Key Resources

Decantr relies on a combination of technological, data-driven, and human resources to operate its platform.

First, technological infrastructure is required to ensure a scalable and reliable web application, including hosting, data management, and system performance.

Second, access to relevant data sources is essential to build and maintain a comprehensive wine database and enable meaningful recommendations and analytics.



Third, human capital plays a key role, as a skilled team is needed for platform development, business operations, and partner management.
Finally, external service providers, such as payment processors, are required to support financial transactions and enable the monetization of the platform.

VII. Key Partners

To scale efficiently and overcome the challenges of a multi-sided platform, Decantr relies on strategic partnerships.

First, partnerships with local wine associations and sellers enable the rapid onboarding of multiple wineries and retailers, supporting the growth of the B2B side of the platform.

Second, collaborations with regional tourism boards position Decantr as a digital extension of local wine tourism, helping to connect visitors with relevant events and venues.

Third, partnerships with sommelier schools and educators help establish the platform as a tool for structured tastings and training, fostering a highly engaged user base.

VIII. Cost Structure

Decantr follows a value-driven cost structure, with a strong focus on initial platform development and ongoing user and partner acquisition.

The main cost components can be divided into three categories. First, platform maintenance represents fixed costs, including hosting infrastructure, data management, and continuous system improvements.

Second, sales and marketing costs are primarily variable and relate to user and partner acquisition. These include customer acquisition costs, digital marketing efforts, and direct outreach to onboard business partners.

Third, administrative and legal costs arise from ensuring compliance with relevant regulations, particularly data protection and industry-specific requirements.

IX. Revenue Streams

To ensure long-term sustainability and scalability, Decantr follows a diversified monetization strategy.

The primary revenue stream is a B2B subscription model, where wineries, wine bars, and event organizers pay recurring fees to access the platform's event management and analytics functionalities, while the platform remains free for consumers.

In addition, Decantr generates revenue through advertising and premium listings. Businesses can increase their visibility by promoting events or offerings through featured placements within the platform.

As an additional revenue stream, Decantr may offer aggregated and anonymized data insights to industry stakeholders, providing valuable information on local market trends and consumer preferences.

Mapping to business model categories

Decantr combines several established web business model categories to create a scalable and sustainable multi-sided platform.

First, Decantr primarily follows a community model, as its core value is based on user participation and engagement. Wine enthusiasts actively contribute content in the form of tasting data, reviews, and interactions, which increases the value of the platform for all users. This strong user involvement fosters network effects and drives platform growth.

Second, the platform incorporates elements of a brokerage model, as it connects wine enthusiasts with wine businesses and facilitates interactions between both sides. While



Decantr does not directly handle transactions, it acts as an intermediary that enables discovery, participation in events, and interaction between users and businesses.

Third, Decantr utilizes a subscription model on the B2B side. Businesses pay recurring fees to access the platform's event management and analytics functionalities, ensuring a stable and predictable revenue stream.

In addition, Decantr integrates aspects of the advertising model, allowing businesses to increase their visibility through promoted listings and targeted exposure within the platform.

Finally, the platform exhibits characteristics of an infomediary model, as it collects and aggregates user-generated data to generate insights about consumer preferences and local market trends. These insights can be used to create additional value for business customers and industry stakeholders.

Overall, Decantr represents a hybrid business model that combines community-driven engagement with subscription-based monetization and data-driven value creation, enabling sustainable growth in a multi-sided platform environment.

